

Privacy Notice for My Shop E-Commerce System

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At My Shop, the privacy and security of our users' personal information is a foundational commitment. This Privacy Notice describes how the My Shop E-Commerce System (the "System") collects, processes, uses, and protects the personal information of all users — including Buyers, Sellers, and Administrators. We encourage all users to read this notice carefully to understand how their data is handled and what rights they hold in relation to that data.

1. Information We Collect

We collect personal information through two primary means: information provided directly by users, and data gathered automatically through interactions with the System.

When registering as a Buyer or Seller, users provide foundational account information including an email address and password. Users may further enrich their profiles by adding delivery addresses and saving preferred payment methods. Sellers are additionally required to supply store profile details, a business address, and relevant contact information necessary to facilitate commercial activity on the platform. Any product reviews or ratings submitted by users following a verified purchase are also stored within the System.

In addition to information provided voluntarily, the System automatically collects certain data to support core functionality. This includes order and transaction history, browsing and interaction data generated during platform use, and authentication and session information required to maintain account security. The AI module draws on browsing activity to power personalized product recommendations and chatbot interactions. System Administrators may access system logs for debugging and auditing purposes; however, sensitive data — including passwords and full payment details — is never logged or exposed through these channels.

2. How We Use Your Information

Personal information collected by the System is used exclusively to operate, maintain, and continuously improve the services we provide. Core uses include facilitating user registration and authentication, enforcing role-based access controls, and managing the full order lifecycle — from cart management and simulated payment processing through to order tracking across statuses such as Created, Paid, and Shipped. We also use contact information to send transactional email communications, including order confirmations and account-related notifications.

The AI-powered features of the System leverage user profile data, order history, and browsing behavior to generate relevant product recommendations and deliver intelligent, context-aware responses through the AI chatbot. This personalization layer is designed to make the shopping experience more efficient and meaningful. User data also supports the platform's security infrastructure, enabling monitoring of failed login attempts, administrative oversight of user accounts, and content moderation to preserve a safe and trustworthy environment.

3. How We Share Your Information

My Shop does not sell personal information to third parties under any circumstances. However, certain data is shared in limited and clearly defined contexts required for the System to function effectively.

Sellers receive the order and shipping information necessary to fulfill customer purchases. Product reviews and ratings submitted by users are displayed publicly within the platform to support informed purchasing decisions by the broader user community. Certain third-party service providers process data on our behalf: AI queries and associated personalization context may be handled by our AI provider (currently Google Gemini API); transactional email notifications are delivered via services such as SendGrid; and payment processing is managed through an external payment gateway. System Administrators retain access to user data strictly for the purposes of monitoring system performance, moderating content, and resolving technical issues.

4. How We Secure Your Information

The security of user data is treated as a critical operational priority. All API communications are encrypted using HTTPS with TLS 1.2 or higher to protect data in transit. User passwords are stored using bcrypt hashing, and accounts are automatically locked following five consecutive failed login attempts to guard against brute-force attacks. The System is built with protections against common web security vulnerabilities, including SQL injection (mitigated via parameterized queries), cross-site scripting (XSS), and cross-site request forgery (CSRF). Secure, short-lived JSON Web Tokens (JWTs) are used to manage authentication sessions, ensuring that user sessions remain protected and time-limited.

5. Your Rights and Choices

Users retain meaningful control over their personal information at all times. Profile details can be viewed and updated directly within the account settings, and users may manage multiple delivery addresses and payment methods as needed. Reviews submitted by users can be edited or deleted at any time. Users who wish to deactivate or permanently delete their account are invited to contact a System Administrator to initiate this process.

6. Data Storage and Retention

The System employs a polyglot persistence architecture to store data efficiently and appropriately according to its type. Core transactional data — including user accounts, product records, and order information — is stored in the primary database management system. Session data and product caches are maintained in Redis for performance, while product information used to support AI-powered search and recommendations is stored in a Chroma vector database. Personal data is retained for as long as a user's account remains active and may be retained beyond account closure where required for auditing purposes or to maintain system integrity.

AI Assistant Limitations & Disclaimer

The My Shop AI Assistant (the "Assistant") is an integrated tool designed to help users navigate the platform, discover products, and obtain answers to common questions. Responses are generated automatically using AI models, including third-party Large Language Models (LLMs) such as Google Gemini.

The Assistant is intended to serve informational and convenience purposes only. While it can provide guidance on product discovery, policy summaries, and frequently asked questions, its responses should not be treated as official, authoritative, or legally binding. AI-generated responses may at times be inaccurate, incomplete, or outdated. Users should also be aware of the phenomenon known as "hallucination," whereby an AI model produces responses that appear plausible but are factually incorrect.

Where the Assistant provides information regarding product pricing or stock availability, this data is drawn from the System's internal database in real time. Nonetheless, the definitive and authoritative source of truth for all pricing and availability information remains the official product listings, cart, and checkout pages. Users should always verify AI-generated outputs against these official sources before making purchasing decisions.

The Assistant is not a substitute for professional human judgment and must not be used as a source of medical, legal, financial, or any other form of specialist advice. The service is provided on an "as is" and "as available" basis, without warranty of any kind regarding accuracy, reliability, or fitness for a particular purpose.

AI Assistant Acceptable Use Policy

To maintain a safe, functional, and respectful environment for all users, interaction with the AI Assistant must adhere to the following standards of acceptable use.

Users are strictly prohibited from using the Assistant to engage in or facilitate harmful or illegal activity. This includes generating content that is hateful, harassing, violent, defamatory, or discriminatory, as well as using the Assistant to plan or assist with any illegal act, including fraud or theft. Attempts to reverse-engineer the Assistant, circumvent its safety filters, or exploit the system for spamming, phishing, or malware distribution are expressly forbidden.

Privacy violations constitute a serious breach of this policy. Users must not attempt, through any means, to uncover or expose the personal information of other users, sellers, or administrators. The submission of sexually explicit content or requests entirely unrelated to the platform's intended purpose is similarly prohibited. System abuse — including the transmission of excessive automated requests that place undue strain on the AI service infrastructure — is also not permitted.

Violations of this Acceptable Use Policy may result in the suspension or permanent termination of access to the AI Assistant and, where appropriate, to My Shop Services more broadly. My Shop reserves the right to take further action in accordance with its platform policies and applicable law.

For further assistance regarding shipping or delivery, please do not hesitate to reach out to our Customer Service team through the Help Center on the My Shop platform.